



GALLERY

A SHOW OF MILESTONES

GALLERY ESPACE CELEBRATES ITS 35TH YEAR BY LOOKING BACK AND STEPPING FORWARD



In the year 1989, a new gallery in Delhi made waves in the art world by opening with an M.F. Husain exhibition. Husain, in fact, had also designed the gallery's logo of a galloping horse. Gallery Espace had begun to push the artistic envelope with multiple large-format exhibitions like *Drawing '94*, *Sculpture '95*, *Miniprint '96* and *The Self and the World* (1997), assembling 16 Indian women artists that featured the likes of Amrita Sher-Gil and Anjolie Ela Menon. Hosted at the National Gallery of Modern Art, the show spelt out the ambitious legacy Gallery Espace would go on to carve.

Thirty-five years since then, it is now taking a moment to look back and reflect on being a witness and a stakeholder in the metamorphosis of the artistic landscape, where every artist of note has graced the walls of this establishment.

"Thirty-five years is such a long history, during which Indian art saw a kind of 360-degree turnaround, and I, fortunately, have stood witness to it," says Renu Modi, founder, Gallery Espace.

She says these decades were an adventure like no other, with her gallery becoming the creative playground—and launchpad—for contemporary greats like Subodh Gupta, Manjunath Kamath, G.R. Iranna, Nilima Sheikh and Zarina Hashmi. Therefore, to mark this milestone, the gallery is set to hold year-long events, beginning with *Ancestral Futures*, an exhibition curated by Damian Christinger, a Swiss curator known for his ability to evoke a cross-cultural dialogue. The show, which will be held at the gallery from October 18 to December 12, brings together Indian and European artists in an homage to its rich and varied journey, juxtaposed against emerging artistic practices for the future.

To celebrate the gallery's extraordinary 35-year history, it is set to hold year-long events

A second exhibition, *Memory Fields*, will be on display at Delhi's Bikaner House from November 29 to December 12, and spotlight seminal artists—like Husain, Manjit Bawa, Sheikh, Kamath and Iranna, among others—who have been pivotal to Gallery Espace's legacy. The show has been curated by Gayatri Sinha, whom Modi refers to as a "fellow traveller," who started writing as an art critic when she became a gallerist.

"In this show, she talks about my and the gallery's journey. So, these two shows complement each other," says Modi.

The inaugural exhibitions will be followed by a series of lectures and talks reflecting on the synergies between art and society, with a spotlight on Hashmi